

Social Story: Making a New Friend

A step-by-step guide to starting a friendship — read together and discuss

About Social Stories

Social stories describe social situations step by step. They help build understanding of what to expect, what others might be thinking, and what I can do. Read this story slowly and discuss each step together.

Step 1: Notice someone I might like to talk to	Sometimes I see other children who might be friendly. They might be playing alone, reading a book I like, or doing something I am interested in. This is a good time to think about saying hello.
Step 2: Moving closer	I can walk slowly toward the person. I don't need to rush. I can stand near them — about one arm's length away — and wait for a good moment. Good moments are when they are not busy or in the middle of something important.
Step 3: Saying hello	I can say: 'Hi, my name is _____. What's your name?' or 'Hi! I like your [book/toy/shirt]. What is it about?' I try to look in the direction of their face. It is okay if I don't make direct eye contact. That is fine.
Step 4: Listening to their answer	When the other person talks, I listen. I try not to interrupt. I can nod or say 'oh!' or 'cool!' to show I am listening. If I don't understand something, I can say: 'I'm not sure I understood — can you say that again?'
Step 5: Finding something in common	I might find out we both like the same game, show, or activity. This is called finding common ground. I can say: 'I like that too!' or 'I've never tried that — what is it like?'
Step 6: Ending the conversation	When it is time to leave or if the conversation feels finished, I can say: 'It was nice talking to you. See you later!' or 'Maybe we can play together again sometime.' This is a friendly way to end.

Practice: My Script

Write your own words for each step (it is okay to copy from above!):

My hello:

My listening phrase:

My ending:

Reflection After Trying

What went well? What was hard? What will I try differently next time?